Joni Halabi

Website Creator, Author, and Speaker

Summary

As a website creator and former self-appointed “middle-end” developer, I enjoy creating accessible websites, developing custom code to support my work, and making up my own titles. I specialize in WordPress site creation, digital accessibility, and creative and technical writing.

Contact

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Skills

- WordPress
- Technical research and writing
- Digital accessibility
- Google Analytics
- Public speaking
- HTML / CSS / SCSS
- Gutenberg API
- JavaScript
- PHP 8
- Twig / Timber
- Markdown
- Eleventy
- Jekyll
- SVG
- Photoshop
- Git / Github

Current Work

Georgetown University

Senior Web Manager – Office of Strategic Communication, *2026 - present*

- Responsible for the development, management, and maintenance of high-visibility Georgetown University websites, including the main university website.
- Ensure that key university websites maintain WCAG 2.1 Level AA accessibility standards.
- Analyze traffic data for key university websites.

Senior Web Manager – Office of the President, *2024 - 2026*

- Developed websites for the Office of the President and other affiliated special initiatives, ensuring that the content and architecture of the sites are engaging and accessible.
- Designed and published a website to commemorate the work of past president John J. DeGioia.
- Was responsible for the website experience for the 2026 Inauguration of President Eduardo Peñalver, where the President’s website experienced an over 500% increase in traffic during the event.

- Completed website redesigns for high-level university initiatives, including Commencement and the Center for the Study of Slavery and its Legacies.
- Research and write engaging content to promote key university initiatives.
- Maintain an organized archive of photos, videos, and other digital assets.

Senior Web Developer – University Information Services, *2016 - 2024*

- Developed a common WordPress framework, used by over 400 departments, schools, and offices across the university.
- Built custom WordPress post editor blocks rendered via a central KSS-based pattern library using the Gutenberg API, PHP, and Twig.
- Authored technical documentation of custom blocks and their integration with an external pattern library.
- Architected a series of PHP-based migration scripts to convert blocks written with the Advanced Custom Fields plugin to custom Gutenberg blocks.
- Converted university site themes from Drupal into WordPress.
- Led the university's accessibility development efforts, resulting in our sites achieving and maintaining WCAG 2.2 AA compliance.

WP Accessibility Day

Translation Team Lead, *2024 - 2026*

- Worked with an all-volunteer team to develop a maintainable and cost-effective plan to translate both past and current WordPress Accessibility Day conference video captions.
- Managed the completion of over 100 translated video captions across 9 spoken languages.

Previous Experience

2015

Lead Web Developer @ Atlantic Media Strategies

- Led and grew the web development team by establishing project workflows.
- Created an internal development resource library, containing base themes and reusable custom libraries and WP plugins.
- Led the development of a redesigned, responsive WordPress website for The Chicago Community Trust, which won the 2015 OMMA award for website excellence.

2009 - 2014

Senior User Experience Developer @ Optaros

- Worked with creative and back-end teams to develop user-focused client e-commerce sites for a variety of enterprise companies, including Macy's, Stella & Dot, and AAA.

Education and Awards

- Current student in the Doctor of Liberal Arts Program, Georgetown University
- **Georgetown University President's Excellence Award**, 2017
- **Master of Fine Arts** in Electronic Arts (M.F.A.), Rensselaer Polytechnic Institute
- **Bachelor of Science** in Electronic Media & Computer Science (B.S.), Rensselaer Polytechnic Institute

Speaking & Teaching Engagements

I love to share my work in web technology, accessibility, and general development practices with audiences big and small. I have been speaking at conferences, meetups, and classrooms since 2015.

- **2025:** Post Status: Women in WordPress: Joni Halabi – *Guest*
- **2025:** Hallway Chats: Episode 178 – A Chat With Joni Halabi – *Guest*
- **2025:** The State of WordPress in Higher Education Research Webinar – *Expert Panelist*
- **2024:** Gutenberg Changelog #110 – *Guest Host*
- **2024:** Gutenberg Changelog #97 – *Guest Host*
- **2023:** Gutenberg Changelog #91 – *Guest Host*
- **2023:** WordPress Accessibility Day – *Speaker*
- **2023:** Gutenberg Times Live Q&A – *Panelist*
- **2023:** WPCampus 2023 – *Speaker*
- **2022:** HighEdWeb 2022 – *Speaker*
- **2022:** Gutenberg Developer Hours – *Panelist*
- **2022:** WordPress Social Learning Meetup – *Panelist*
- **2021:** HighEdWeb 2021 – *Speaker*
- **2021:** WPCampus Online 2021 – *Speaker*
- **2020:** WPCampus Online 2020 – *Speaker*
- **2020:** JavaScript for WordPress Conference – *Speaker*
- **2019:** WPCampus Online 2019 – *Speaker*
- **2017:** edUi – *Speaker*
- **2017:** ConvergeSE – *Speaker*
- **2017:** NoVA Code Camp – *Speaker*
- **2015-2016:** General Assembly – *Instructor, Front-end web development*
- **2015:** Northern Virginia Community College – *Guest Instructor*